



Subject Vision and Intent: Music

Our Vision

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that music is a powerful form of expression that enriches children's lives, nurtures creativity and enables them to connect with others and the world around them. Our ambition is for every child to leave KCA seeing themselves as a musician: able to listen with understanding, perform with confidence, create their own music and experience the enjoyment that comes from making music with others.

In our diverse community, music provides opportunities for children to explore their own identities while encountering musical traditions, styles and cultures beyond their own experiences. We want children to appreciate the richness and diversity of music and understand that it can communicate ideas, emotions, stories and experiences across cultures and generations.

Our Music curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*. Music is inherently collaborative: children listen to one another, perform together, share ideas and experience the collective achievement of creating something as an ensemble. Through rehearsal and performance, children also develop our KCA values, particularly the courage to perform, the endurance to practise and improve, and the aspiration to achieve something of which they can be proud.

Our Intent

Our Music curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential musical knowledge, vocabulary, concepts and practical skills we want children to develop from the Early Years to Year 6, enabling them to become increasingly knowledgeable, confident and independent musicians.

Our curriculum develops musicianship through listening, performing and composing. These interconnected elements allow children to experience music practically while developing an increasingly sophisticated understanding of how music works.

Children listen to and encounter a carefully chosen range of music from different periods, traditions, cultures and genres. They learn to listen with increasing attention and discrimination, identifying musical features, expressing informed responses and developing

an appreciation of the extraordinary breadth of music that exists within and beyond their own experiences.

Through singing and instrumental performance, children develop control, accuracy, fluency and expression. Musical knowledge and skills are deliberately built over time, with children revisiting and deepening their understanding of important concepts including pulse, rhythm, pitch, dynamics, tempo, timbre, texture, structure and notation.

Composition provides opportunities for children to apply this knowledge creatively. They experiment with sound, improvise, develop musical ideas and make purposeful choices about how music can be organised and communicated. As their musicianship develops, children become increasingly able to explain, refine and evaluate their creative decisions.

Musical vocabulary and notation are taught progressively so that children develop the language and tools needed to think, talk and communicate as musicians. Children learn that becoming a musician involves listening carefully, practising deliberately, responding to feedback and returning to a piece repeatedly in order to improve.

Every Child

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious Music curriculum and the wider musical opportunities available at KCA.

Teachers identify the essential musical knowledge and skills that all children need and adapt teaching so that barriers are reduced without lowering expectations. Modelling, repetition, visual representations, appropriate instruments and technology, carefully structured rehearsal and opportunities to experience music practically enable all children to participate successfully.

We recognise that children's opportunities to experience music and learn an instrument outside school can vary significantly. Our curriculum therefore ensures that access to high-quality music education and practical music-making does not depend upon a child's circumstances or prior experience.

Every child is given opportunities to sing, play instruments, compose, listen and perform. We want all children to experience the satisfaction of developing their musicianship and the sense of belonging that comes from making music alongside others.

Music Beyond the Curriculum

Our commitment to music extends beyond classroom lessons. We provide children with opportunities to perform, collaborate and experience what it means to be part of a wider musical community.

Alongside their curriculum learning, children experience instrumental tuition, enabling them to develop practical musicianship and experience the discipline and enjoyment of learning an instrument. By the time they leave King's Cross Academy, our ambition is that every child will have had the opportunity to learn at least two musical instruments.

Children can also participate in our school choir, developing their vocal skills and experiencing the enjoyment and challenge of ensemble performance. Performances within school, across Camden and at significant venues including the Royal Albert Hall give children opportunities to perform for authentic audiences and celebrate their achievements.

Through these experiences, children encounter musicians and musical organisations beyond school and experience music as something living and shared rather than something that exists only within a lesson.

By the end of Year 6, our aim is not simply that children know about music, but that they can make music. We want them to listen attentively and knowledgeably, sing and play with increasing fluency and expression, create and develop their own musical ideas and understand the musical concepts that underpin what they hear and perform.

Above all, we want children to leave KCA with the confidence to participate in music, the curiosity to explore music beyond what they already know and, most importantly, a belief that music is for them.